

Cherry-White Chocolate Drop Cookies are ideal for those with a relaxed approach in the kitchen.

Cherry-White Chocolate Drop Cookies

Makes 2 dozen cookies

2 sticks (1 cup) butter, softened

½ cup granulated sugar

½ cup packed brown sugar

1 egg

1 teaspoon almond extract

¼ cup milk

3 cups all-purpose flour

½ teaspoon baking soda

½ cup dried cherries

½ cup dried cranberries

1 cup white chocolate chips

Heat the oven to 375 degrees. Line two baking sheets with kitchen parchment.

In a large bowl, use an electric mixer to beat the butter and both sugars until fluffy, 2 to 3 minutes. Add the egg, almond extract and milk, then mix well. Add the flour and baking soda, then mix just until the dry ingredients are well mixed in. Mix in the cherries, cranberries and chocolate chips.

Drop the dough in 2-tablespoon mounds on the prepared baking sheets, leaving 2 inches between them. Bake, in batches if necessary, for 12 to 14 minutes, or until just lightly browned at the edges and still slightly soft at the center. Leave on the baking sheet for 2 minutes, then use a spatula to transfer to a wire rack to cool completely.

Nutrition information per serving: 210 calories, 90 calories from fat (43 percent of total calories), 10 grams fat (6 grams saturated, no trans fats), 30 milligrams cholesterol, 28 grams carbohydrate, 1 gram fiber, 15 grams sugar, 3 grams protein, 40 milligrams sodium.

White Chocolate, Cranberry, and Macadamia Nut Cookies

MAKES 36 (LARGE) OR 72 (SMALL)

- 3 cups all purpose flour
- 1 teaspoon baking soda
- $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon salt
- 1 cup (2 sticks) unsalted butter, room temperature
- 1 cup (packed) golden brown sugar
- $\frac{3}{4}$ cup sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tablespoon vanilla extract
- $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups dried cranberries (about 6 ounces)
- $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups white chocolate chips (about $8\frac{1}{2}$ ounces)
- 1 cup coarsely chopped roasted salted macadamia nuts (about $4\frac{1}{2}$ ounces)

Preheat oven to 350°F. Line 2 large rimmed baking sheets with parchment paper. Sift first 3 ingredients into medium bowl. Using electric mixer, beat butter in large bowl until fluffy. Add both sugars and beat until blended. Beat in eggs, 1 at a time, then vanilla. Add dry ingredients and beat just until blended. Using spatula, stir in cranberries, white chocolate chips, and nuts.

For large cookies, drop dough by heaping tablespoonfuls onto prepared sheets, spacing $2\frac{1}{2}$ inches apart. For small cookies, drop dough by level tablespoonfuls onto sheets, spacing $1\frac{1}{2}$ inches apart.

Bake cookies until just golden, about 18 minutes for large cookies and about 15 minutes for small cookies. Cool on sheets. **DO AHEAD** Can be made ahead. Store airtight at room temperature up to 2 days or freeze up to 2 weeks.